FOUNDATIONS OF GENERATIVE AI (ICT4403)

Assignment 2: Autoregressive Text Generation System — Comparative Study

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Assignment Title	Assignment 2 - Autoregressive Text Generation System
System Title	Comparative Word-Level Autoregressive Text Generation on Lewis Carroll's Alice in Wonderland using Simple RNN, BiRNN, LSTM, GRU
Dataset & Source	Alice's Adventures in Wonderland (Lewis Carroll) | https://www.gutenberg.org/files/11/11-0.txt
GitHub Repository	https://github.com/Saksham-Gupta-GH/fgai-autoregressive-text-generation-alice

1. System Overview & Problem Statement

Four recurrent neural language models (Simple RNN, BiRNN with forward-backward final state concatenation [h_n[-2], h_n[-1]], LSTM, and GRU) were trained under strictly controlled conditions on Alice's Adventures in Wonderland. To eliminate data leakage, the corpus is partitioned chronologically (80% Train, 10% Val, 10% Test) and the vocabulary (1,300 tokens, min_freq=2) is fitted exclusively on training tokens. Context sequence length is 6 tokens.

2. Quantitative Evaluation Summary (Best Epoch & Test Set)

Architecture	Parameters	Best Ep	Val Loss	Val PPL	Val Top-1	Test Loss	Test Top-1	Test Top-5
Simple RNN	798,484	4	4.0741	58.80	19.73%	4.1584	20.80%	45.28%
BiRNN	1,262,868	2	4.2804	72.27	18.66%	4.3192	18.47%	42.26%
LSTM	1,193,236	5	**3.9903**	**54.07**	**21.87%**	**4.0576**	**23.29%**	**47.23%**
GRU	1,061,652	3	4.0353	56.56	20.55%	4.0900	22.53%	46.51%

3. Cross-Model Temperature Analysis (Averaged Over Models and Seed Prompts, n = 3 per cell)

Temperature	Distinct-1	Distinct-2	Trigram Repetition	Longest Loop	Empirical Quality Observation
T = 0.2	0.517	0.674	23.7%	0–6 words	Strict syntax; repetitive looping traps across models (GRU 52.5%)
T = 0.5	0.678	0.900	3.0%	0 words	Optimal empirical trade-off: high diversity with fluent story dialogue; LSTM and GRU comparable
T = 1.0	0.855	0.992	0.0%	0 words	High lexical richness; slight syntactic drift across longer clauses
T = 1.5	0.916	1.000	0.0%	0 words	High entropy; syntactic collapse into ungrammatical token sequences

4. Conclusion & Model Comparison

• **LSTM and GRU Comparison:** LSTM edges ahead across prediction metrics (Val Loss 3.9903, PPL 54.07, Test Top-1 23.29%), with GRU performing closely behind (Val Loss 4.0353, Test Top-1 22.53%) while requiring 11% fewer parameters. Simple RNN remains competitive in loss (4.0741). For text generation, LSTM and GRU are comparable: GRU achieves 0.0% trigram repetition at T=0.5, while LSTM produces the most fluent story phrasing in our samples.
• **Single-Seed Limitation:** Experiments were run under SEED=42 for strict controlled comparison; the 0.045 loss delta between LSTM and GRU falls within typical single-run variance margins. Evaluating across 3–5 seeds with mean ± std is recommended for production-scale validation.
• **Bidirectional RNN:** Concatenating forward state h_n[-2] and backward state h_n[-1] feeds complete context to the classifier, but its 1,262,868 parameters overfit by epoch 2 (val loss 4.2804).
• **Temperature Sampling:** T = 0.5 provides the optimal trade-off between lexical diversity (Distinct-1: 0.60–0.73) and phrase stability, achieving low repetition across models (LSTM 5.0%, GRU 0.0%, BiRNN 1.0%, Simple RNN 6.1%).